SpeechGeek

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One of our goals in publishing **SpeechGeek** is to introduce the forensic world to new and talented writers. Traditional publishers often neglect promising writers. Other publishers are often clueless as to the needs of forensics performers. The material found in **SpeechGeek** is written by veteran and new forensic students and coaches. We strive to provide a product that is fresh and challenges the conventions of what makes a great performance. The most rewarding part of this process is that the material is left in your hands to make the final decision. You get to explore the emotions, characters, and stories. We may provide the material, but the end result is completely up to you. **Season Three starts here and what a season it will be!**

Corey Alderdice
Publisher

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Pipe Dreams

by Andy Birge

NARR. In a time long past, there once lived a man and his brother with the ability to make right where there was once wrong, peace where there was chaos, and nothing where there was once spaghetti. These that I speak of are the brothers Mario...

LUIGI. Wait! Why does it have to be all about Mario? Mario....Mario...Mario...

NARR. But isn't your last name Mario?

LUIGI. Well...yeah, but I mean...WHAT KIND OF NAME IS MARIO MARIO ANYWAY? (*turns away sobbing*)

(Toadstool wanders into the room.)

TOAD. Hhhheeey guys...you got any candy? (*staggers*)

LUIGI. What's up Toadstool? Look at me. Let me see your eyes. Are you drunk again?

TOAD. Yeah. So?

LUIGI. SO, it's 9:30 in the morning.

TOAD. Hey, let me tell you something, I love you man...No, I mean it...I really love you man...(*mumbles off*)

LUIGI. Have you paid the utilities yet?

NARR. Like I was saying before, the Mario Brothers have revolutionized our world as well as the Mushroom Kingdom. I am here today with Luigi Mario, faithful sidekick and brother to the world famous Mario Mario. So, Luigi, I see that you have gained a few pounds since we last saw you. What happened?

LUIGI. Well, mainly, I was tired of maintaining my image. After our life story was made into a movie, my reputation was ruined. I attribute the fall of my career to John Leguizamo. Hollywood wanted to make me seem like the pansy sidekick. Back in the day, I ran the game.

NARR. So, what have you and the crew been up to over the past fifteen years?

LUIGI. Well, Mario and I don't speak much since the plumbing business went down the drain. No pun intended. Since he went on the Atkin's diet, he thinks he's too good for me, rolling in royalties and spaghetti sauce. He doesn't eat the noodles anymore, though—or the mushrooms.

NARR. No mushrooms?

LUIGI. Well, the mushrooms from the Kingdom are *really* high in carbs. Haven't you seen that fool? He's emaciated, but he still has the best parties, I'll give him that. Everyone's there...me and Toad, the Princess, all the goombas, Bowser...

NARR. Bowser?

LUIGI. Oh, Bowser gave up his life of crime long ago when he married. It's shunned upon and everything--marrying outside of the game. It's an issue to some, but I don't care.

(Cut to interview with Bowser, AKA King Koopa.)

BOWSER. There is only one way. We must find the light that lies within us in order to find our ultimate purpose. Isn't that right, honey?

WIFE. Of course, Bowzie.

NARR. So tell me, how did you meet?

BOWSER. Well, one day I was at the bottom of a castle throwing fireballs at tourists and I realized I was missing something. A hole that no fireball could fill: the hole of true love. In the past, every woman I abducted was rescued, but this time, I knew she would rescue me.

NARR. So....*how* did you meet?

Take 43

by Collin Aldridge

The scene opens
with an
unfocused wide-angle shot
of a house on the
bluff in the Palisades.
It's mine.
The two vehicles parked outside,
not to mention the
convertible and Land Cruiser
in the garage,
are mine as well.
A soft melodic theme song
fades in as Camera One
pulls up closer to the house.
A clean rack focus on an upstairs window displays a bedroom.
It's mine. A slow dolly
pans the room,
showing its size,
and then rests on an unmade bed.
One half wrinkled and slept in,
the other half still made.
That's mine too.
Now fade to black.

My name is Geoff
and that's all you need to know.
Nothing else is really important.
That script is still
in its first draft.
My name is spelled G-E-O-F-F,
it's a Hollywood name.

In my life I have directed 11 films,
I tried television but it wasn't my style.
I like risk.
I like blood.
I like flesh.
I like being able to put the "fuck"
in a sentence without having to
worry about TV censorship.
That "fuck" is what sells.
It's not the "poop"
or the "dump"
or the "turds" that sell.

It's the "shit."
My biggest pet peeve is when one of my films will have its television premiere.
The climax scene
with that perfect low angle of our hero
will come up and audiences are psyched.
Then you hear one of two things.
You hear a sentence of bleeps,

those mother-fucking bleeps
or,
if they don't bleep them,
the censory board throws in words that don't make sense.
"Listen punk! I WILL KICK YOUR 'behind'! Why don't you get out of my face and go (fight) yourself!"
And it's not even well-bleeped.

You hear
Go fu-ight yourself.
What the hell is that? What in the hell is that?

My days are busy,
but I try to splice them with my own instances of love and security,
I am so damn single.
I just have no time,
or desire,
to have anything serious.

My work is my life.
Every time I have tried directing a love flick,
I have failed miserably.
There's just something about
hypocrisy
that fosters unrealistic feelings.

Anyway, here I am.
I wake up next to this beautiful woman.
It's dark outside.
I pull the covers away,
glancing down at her barely covered body.
She has the curves of a question mark.
Relaxed.
Asleep.
Curving and
entangling herself in the sheets.
The story line is simple.
The script is even simpler.
Not much dialogue.
In this particular case,
two people are working on a feature together. Work leads to drinks.
He buys her a few and comments on things she is hoping to hear as her mind puts his celebrity name in rewind over and over in her mind.
Two hours later her body is
wrapped in my silk sheets.
There should be some sort of triumphant music playing in the background now.
A smell of sex envelops the room and the scene fades to a cold black.
Cut.
Take 2.

I wake up and this
beautiful woman is
tangled in me.
I feel her curves as her brown hair
dances with each of
my exhales.
I wipe the sleep from my eyes
and look over again,

an empty
space next to me.
Cut.
Take 3.

A great movie has to
accomplish one of three things.
Believability.
Entertainment.
Relateability.
Those three details are what decide whether a film is going box office or not.
Love stories are believable because they represent what every person in this world hopes for.
It's what people dream about.
And they believe it. They make themselves believe it.
Action flicks are entertaining.
They may not be true-to-life,
but their sole reason for existence is to entertain.
Entertainment makes money.
And third, when a moviegoer can
waltz into a theatre, and two hours later leaves saying, "I could relate with that character, I felt his pain."
YOU HAVE SUCCEEDED.
End of story.
Take 4.

What are the characteristics that make a perfect life?
What...a perfect life?
What...my perfect life...
My perfect life...
My perfect life.

Believability!
Entertainment!
Relateability!

Believability!
Entertainment!
Relateability!

Believability!
Entertainment!
Relateability!
My life.
My life.
Not entertaining unless you don't know the half of it.

A person could relate to it if they were a hooker.

Believability...Believability...
I still have believability.
A man worth millions of dollars.

I am worth millions of dollars.
Who sleeps with hundreds of women
Who works 12 hours a day.
And who lives BY HIMSELF.
And lives in a fucking big house.

Oh, but if my story was modified to fit your screen, it would be...
“live in a big (fucking) house.”

That’s believable, right?
This is worth the box office.

Now dissolve to a bedroom,
contemporary-style decor,
hardwood floors,
art deco design,
Onica on the far wall
where a man in his early to mid-thirties
is lying in bed, tangled in his sheets.
Fade in music.

I wake up and this beautiful woman
spoons alongside me.
I feel her curves, hot breath bending the pillowcase as she exhales.
I roll over and consult my clock.
8:02.
I wipe the sleep from my eyes and
look over to my sleeping beauty,
Now an empty space next to me.
Cut!
Pull into a close-up.
I want to feel this!
We’re rolling.

I turn over and the silk sheets
are unmoved.
Unwrinkled.
Cut! Dammit.
Take 6!
And I look over at an empty space next to me.
Cut!
Take 8.
An empty space—
Dammit!
Take 11! What in the holy shit is going on here? Why the (fuck) is this not working?
Take 15.
Take 43!
I just want to know why is so (fucking) difficult...This scene should be perfect.

How can this be so hard?
Cut...

I walk to the bathroom mirror,
splash cold water on my face and
try to peer inside.
I stare back at myself for what seems like hours
searching for some sign of believability.
My eyes stay...unfocused.
I stare—
trying to dissect the working of my mind
but I just can’t figure out how.

I look back over at the bed and the space beside mine is unmoved.
Unrustled.

Not wrinkled.
Empty.
(sighs)
Fade up.

A high single shot of the house
makes it seem more average,
less powerful,
less controlling.
Through the bedroom window
Camera 1 pulls in.
I roll over and feel her body spooned in mind. Her skin is stain and her breathing is almost breathless.
(surprised)
She is still there.
I sit up straight, ponder the room and my situation,
I look again.
Still there.
Zoom in.
Still there.
Bring in music. Fade out.
Cut.
That's a wrap.